TRACK 01 / MAC

Final Cut Pro

01 / Set up the job

Build a portable project before making the first cut.

01 Create Media, Audio, Graphics, Exports and Archive folders. Copy camera originals to your working drive and confirm a separate backup before clearing any card.

02 Create one library for the job. Make an event for the footage and a project for the edit. Confirm the delivery frame size and frame rate before building the timeline.

03 On import, choose whether to copy media into the library or leave it in a controlled folder. If editing 4K footage is sluggish, create proxy media and test playback.

PRACTICE DEMO

Import one talking-head clip, two cutaways and ten seconds of room tone. Reopen the library and confirm the media still plays.

QUICK CHECK / FAQ

If a clip goes offline, relink to the original folder and check that its filenames were preserved.

Open the official illustrated reference >

TRACK 01 / MAC

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02 / Edit in the Magnetic Timeline

Use the primary storyline for story beats and keep supporting material connected.

01 Build a 30-second spoken story with a clear hook, one explanation and a closing line. Make the dialogue intelligible before adding graphics.

02 Add two B-roll clips above the primary storyline. Connect each at the word it illustrates, then move the underlying story beat and observe what follows it.

03 Ripple a cut shorter to tighten pacing. Use the Position tool deliberately when timing must stay fixed and check for the gap clip it leaves.

PRACTICE DEMO

Make one version with straight cuts and one with B-roll over a dialogue edit. Compare which explains the idea faster.

QUICK CHECK / FAQ

If B-roll moves with the wrong shot, inspect and reposition its connection before rearranging the primary storyline.

Open the official illustrated reference >

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Final Cut Pro

03 / Mix dialogue and use roles

Keep dialogue clear and make the handoff easy to audit.

01 Assign Dialogue and Effects roles to the appropriate clips. Use the timeline index to isolate each role and identify mistakes.

02 Adjust clip gain before reaching for heavy noise reduction. Listen with headphones, then at low volume on a laptop or phone.

03 Add short fades at dialogue joins and a bed of clean room tone underneath gaps. Check the final output against the client or platform audio specification.

PRACTICE DEMO

Mute the Effects role and play the piece. The spoken edit should still make complete sense.

QUICK CHECK / FAQ

A role that is disabled in the timeline can be omitted from exports. Review enabled roles and playback before delivery.

Open the official illustrated reference >

TRACK 01 / MAC

Final Cut Pro

04 / Color, captions and reframing

Match shots first, then add a restrained finish.

01 Use video scopes and a neutral reference to correct white balance and exposure. Match the interview angles before adding a creative look.

02 Build a short caption sequence. Review spelling, timing and whether each line remains readable on a phone.

03 Duplicate the project for vertical delivery. Reframe shots intentionally and place titles clear of the edges and interface overlays.

PRACTICE DEMO

Deliver matching landscape and vertical versions of the same 15-second excerpt. Check each crop against the subject’s movement.

QUICK CHECK / FAQ

If color changes between the viewer and the export, confirm the project color space and view the exported file on your intended playback device.

Open the official illustrated reference >

TRACK 01 / MAC

Final Cut Pro

05 / Multicam and delivery

Turn the edit into a master, a review copy and an archive.

01 Make a multicam clip from two views of the same take. Label angles, sync by waveform or timecode and verify sync near the end of the recording.

02 Keep the best microphone as the audio source while switching video angles. Use an angle change only when it improves clarity or rhythm.

03 Switch the viewer back to optimized or original media as appropriate, export a high-quality master and a smaller review file, then play both files from disk.

PRACTICE DEMO

Submit a 45 to 60-second interview edit, a review MP4, and a handoff note with frame size, frame rate and caption format.

QUICK CHECK / FAQ

If export fails, verify free disk space, original media availability and the selected Share destination.

Open the official illustrated reference >

TRACK 01 / MAC

Final Cut Pro

06 / Capstone and FAQ

Make a one-minute case-study video with a complete handoff.

01 Use a five-shot minimum and a dialogue-led story. Open on a clear outcome, add context, then end with the result or next step.

02 Deliver a 16:9 master, one 9:16 cut, captions if required, and a folder with the project and linked assets.

03 Quality check continuity, lip sync, captions, audio peaks, brand spellings, export specs and the first and last frames.

PRACTICE DEMO

Score yourself out of 10: story clarity 3, clean audio 2, picture and captions 2, export QC 2, organised handoff 1.

QUICK CHECK / FAQ

Can I use proxies for final output? Return to available originals or optimized media for the master and inspect the result before delivery.

Open the official illustrated reference >